

Word family: **resign / resigns / resigned / resigning / resignation / resignedly**

Base word: resign

Past tense: resigned

Past participle: resigned

** -ing form:** resigning

Major related forms:

* resignation

* resigned — also an independent adjective

* resignedly

Major constructions/extensions:

* resign from a job/company/organization

* resign as manager/director/chair

* resign one's position/post

* resign with immediate effect

* resign over something

* resign in protest

* resign on principle

* resign under pressure

* be forced/asked to resign

* hand in / submit / tender one's resignation

* resignation letter

* accept / withdraw a resignation

* resign one's commission

* resign a game

* resign oneself to something

* be resigned to something

* with resignation

* resigned attitude/look/tone

* **re-sign** — separate word meaning “sign again”

Part of speech: verb (動詞)

Related noun/adjective/adverb: resignation, resigned, resignedly

Your passage:

> “On balance, my advice is clear: do not **resign** immediately.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **resign** means **to voluntarily leave one's job or formally give up one's position**.

Kam Chai is considering leaving his present company in order to open a café.

****繁體中文：****

*** **辭職****

*** **辭去職位****

*** **主動離職****

A natural translation is:

> “do not ****resign**** immediately”

「不要立即****辭職****。」

The important implication is:

> ****the employee initiates the departure****, rather than the employer dismissing them.

A. RESIGN = VOLUNTARILY LEAVE A JOB

1. ****resign = formally give up one's job (辭職) ****

This is the exact passage sense.

> “She decided to resign.”

「她決定****辭職****。」

> “He resigned after five years with the company.”

「他在公司工作五年後****辭職****。」

****resign = 正式表示自己不再繼續擔任現有職位****

2. ****resign from one's job = 辭去工作****

> “He resigned from his job to start a business.”

「他辭去工作去創業。」

Very common pattern:

> ****resign from + job/organization****

3. ****resign from a company / organization****

> “She resigned from the company last month.”

「她上月從公司****辭職****。」

Here ****from**** identifies the organization being left.

4. ****resign one's position = 辭去職位****

More formal:

> “He resigned his position as finance director.”

「他辭去了財務董事的職位。」

This transitive construction is fully standard.

5. ****resign one's post = 辭職 / 辭去職務****

> “She resigned her post.”

「她****辭去職務****。」

****Post**** usually sounds more formal/institutional than ****job****.

B. ****RESIGN FROM vs RESIGN AS****

This distinction is highly important.

6. ****resign from + organization/job/body****

> “She resigned ****from the board****.”

「她退出董事會 / 辭去董事職務。」

> “He resigned **from the company**.”

「他從公司辭職。」

7. **resign as + role/title**

> “She resigned **as chairperson**.”

「她辭去**主席職務**。」

> “He resigned as manager.”

「他辭去**經理職位**。」

So:

> **from** = where you are leaving

> **as** = the role you are giving up.

8. **resign from X as Y**

Both can appear together:

> “She resigned from the company as chief executive.”

More naturally in many contexts:

> “She resigned as chief executive of the company.”

「她辭去公司的行政總裁職務。」

C. RESIGN A SENIOR / OFFICIAL POSITION

9. **resign from office = 辭去公職 / 職務**

Formal institutional use.

> “He resigned from office.”

「他**辭去職務**。」

This can apply to many kinds of office, not only employment.

10. **resign a directorship = 辭去董事職務**

Corporate use:

> “She resigned her directorship.”

「她辭去**董事職務**。」

11. **resign from the board = 辭去董事 / 委員職務**

> “Two directors resigned from the board.”

「兩名董事辭去了董事會職務。」

12. **resign as chair / director / trustee / officer**

Formal organizational language:

- * resign as chair
- * resign as director
- * resign as trustee
- * resign as officer

The precise formal process may depend on the organization and applicable law.

13. **resign from a committee**

> “She resigned from the committee.”

「她退出 / 辭去委員會職務。」

Depending on context this can mean:

- * give up membership;
- * give up an official committee role.

14. **resign membership / resign from an association**

Formal:

> “He resigned from the association.”

「他退出該協會。」

For ordinary memberships, **leave** is often more conversational.

D. RESIGNATION NOTICE

15. **give notice of resignation = 正式通知辭職**

> “She gave two months' notice of resignation.”

「她提前兩個月正式通知**辭職**。」

16. **give notice = 提出離職通知**

In employment contexts:

> “I've given notice.”

often means:

> I have formally notified my employer that I am leaving.

It can overlap strongly with resigning.

17. **notice period = 離職通知期**

The period between notification and the end of employment under the relevant contract/law.

This is a related employment construction, not a separate sense of **resign**.

E. RESIGNATION LETTER

18. **resignation letter = 辭職信**

> “He submitted his resignation letter on Monday.”

「他星期一提交了**辭職信**。」

The letter communicates the resignation.

Important:

> **resignation ≠ resignation letter**

The resignation is the act/decision; the letter is the document communicating it.

19. **letter of resignation = 辭職信**

More formal equivalent:

> “She submitted a letter of resignation.”

F. HAND IN / SUBMIT / TENDER A RESIGNATION

20. **hand in one's resignation = 提交辭呈**

Common especially BrE:

> “She handed in her resignation.”

「她**遞交了辭呈**。」

21. **submit one's resignation = 提交辭呈**

More formal:

> “The director submitted his resignation.”

「董事提交了**辭呈**。」

22. **tender one's resignation = 正式呈辭**

Very formal/institutional:

> “She tendered her resignation.”

「她正式**呈辭**。」

Tender here means formally offer/submit.

G. ACCEPT A RESIGNATION

23. **accept someone's resignation = 接受某人的辭呈**

> “The board accepted her resignation.”

「董事會接受了她的**辭呈**。」

This is common organizational wording.

Whether formal acceptance is legally necessary for resignation to take effect depends on the relevant employment/office rules.

24. **resignation accepted**

Formal announcement language:

> “His resignation was accepted.”

「他的辭呈獲得接受。」

H. WITHDRAW A RESIGNATION

25. **withdraw one's resignation = 撤回辭職決定 / 辭呈**

> “She later asked to withdraw her resignation.”

「她後來要求**撤回辭呈**。」

Whether withdrawal is possible as of right or requires agreement depends on the specific employment/legal context.

I. EFFECTIVE DATE

26. **resignation takes effect = 辭職生效**

> “His resignation takes effect next month.”

「他的辭職下月**生效**。」

27. **effective resignation date = 離職生效日期**

28. **resign with immediate effect = 即時辭職**

Practice

> “She resigned with immediate effect.”

「她**即時辭職**。」

Formal and common.

29. **resign immediately / resign on the spot**

immediately

立即辭職

on the spot

當場辭職

The second is more dramatic/informal.

Your passage advises:

> ****do not resign immediately****

because Kam Chai should prepare first.

J. RESIGN FOR A REASON

30. ****resign over something = 因某問題而辭職****

> “The manager resigned over the dispute.”

「經理因這場爭議而****辭職****。」

****over**** identifies the issue prompting resignation.

31. ****resign because of X****

Straightforward causal construction.

32. ****resign for personal reasons = 因私人理由辭職****

A very common formal phrase.

It does not specify the actual personal reason.

33. ****resign for health reasons / on health grounds****

> “She resigned on health grounds.”

「她因健康理由****辭職****。」

Formal.

34. ****resign to pursue another opportunity****

Business/professional wording:

> “He resigned to pursue other opportunities.”

「他辭職去尋求其他發展機會。」

K. RESIGN IN PROTEST

35. **resign in protest = 以辭職表示抗議**

> “Several members resigned in protest.”

「數名成員以**辭職表示抗議**。」

The act of resigning itself communicates disagreement.

36. **protest resignation = 抗議性辭職**

A resignation intended partly as a public statement.

L. RESIGN ON PRINCIPLE

37. **resign on principle = 因原則問題而辭職**

> “She resigned on principle rather than approve the decision.”

「她基於**原則問題選擇辭職**，而不是批准該決定。」

M. RESIGN UNDER PRESSURE

38. **resign under pressure = 在壓力下辭職**

> “He eventually resigned under pressure.”

「他最終在壓力下**辭職**。」

Important nuance:

The formal act may still be called a resignation even when the person had little practical choice.

39. **be pressured to resign = 被施壓辭職**

40. **be asked to resign = 被要求辭職**

This is softer/formal wording that may function differently from a purely voluntary resignation.

41. **be forced to resign = 被迫辭職**

This creates an important distinction:

> **resignation** is formally employee/office-holder initiated,

but circumstances may make it highly involuntary in practical terms.

N. RESIGN IN DISGRACE

42. **resign in disgrace = 因醜聞 / 失敗而羞愧離職**

> “He resigned in disgrace.”

「他在聲譽受損的情況下**黯然辭職**。」

Strongly negative.

O. RESIGN RATHER THAN BE FIRED

43. **resign rather than be dismissed/fired**

> “He chose to resign rather than be dismissed.”

「他選擇**辭職，而不是等公司解僱他**。」

Important distinction:

> formal resignation ≠ dismissal.

P. MASS RESIGNATION

44. **mass resignation = 集體 / 大規模辭職**

When many people leave simultaneously or within a short period.

45. **wave of resignations = 辭職潮**

> “The organization faced a wave of resignations.”

「機構面對一波**辭職潮**。」

46. **the Great Resignation = 「大辭職潮」**

A widely used label for the unusually high levels of voluntary job quitting associated particularly with the labor-market upheaval around and after the COVID-era period.

This is a conventional social/economic label rather than a separate dictionary sense of **resignation**.

Q. MILITARY: RESIGN ONE'S COMMISSION

47. **resign one's commission = 辭去軍官委任 / 軍職**

A commissioned officer may **resign their commission** under the applicable military rules.

> “He resigned his commission.”

「他辭去其**軍官委任 / 軍職**。」

This is distinct from:

- * retirement;
- * discharge;
- * dismissal from service.

48. **resignation of commission**

Formal noun construction.

R. ACADEMIC / PROFESSIONAL OFFICE

49. **resign a chair / professorship / appointment**

Formal:

> “She resigned her university chair.”

「她辭去了大學的**教授席位 / 教席**。」

Institutional and lower-frequency.

S. ECCLESIASTICAL / HISTORICAL

50. **resign a benefice/living = give up a church office (辭去聖職 / 教會俸祿職位) **

Historical/ecclesiastical terminology.

A cleric could:

> resign a benefice

meaning formally relinquish the ecclesiastical office.

Database priority: specialist/historical.

T. GAMES: RESIGN = CONCEDE THE GAME

Now a major independent branch.

51. **resign = concede that one has lost and stop playing (認輸) **

Especially common in chess.

> “White resigned after 35 moves.”

「白方在第 35 步後**認輸**。」

No employment meaning whatsoever.

52. **resign a game = 認輸退出一局**

> “He resigned the game.”

「他**認輸結束了這一局**。」

53. **resignation — chess/game = 認輸**

> “The mistake led to immediate resignation.”

「這個失誤令他立即**認輸**。」

54. **resign button — online games**

Online chess/strategy platforms may have a:

> **Resign**

button

= **認輸 / 投降**

This is an interface application of the game sense.

55. **resign vs draw — chess**

resign

concede defeat.

offer/agree a draw

end without either player winning.

Completely different outcome.

U. RESIGN = GIVE UP / SURRENDER A RIGHT OR POSSESSION

56. **resign something = formally give it up (放棄 ; 讓出) — formal/older**

Historically/formally, **resign** can mean:

> surrender or relinquish a right, claim, office, possession, or authority.

Example:

> “He resigned all claim to the estate.”

Approximately:

「他**放棄**對遺產的一切權利主張。」

Modern English normally prefers:

* relinquish

* surrender

* renounce

* give up

for many such objects.

57. **resign authority/power = 交出權力 — older/formal**

> “The ruler resigned his authority.”

≈

「統治者**交出了權力**。」

Rare in modern general English.

58. **resign a claim/right = 放棄權利 / 主張**

Formal/old-fashioned.

V. RESIGN ONESELF TO SOMETHING

This is the second major modern meaning and must be kept distinct from employment resignation.

59. **resign oneself to something = reluctantly accept that an unpleasant situation cannot be changed (無奈接受 ; 認命) **

Practice

> “He resigned himself to waiting another year.”

「他只好**無奈接受 / 認命**，再等一年。」

Practice

> “She resigned herself to the possibility of failure.”

「她只好**接受可能失敗這個現實**。」

This does **not** mean:

> quit a job.

60. **resign oneself to + noun**

> “He resigned himself to defeat.”

「他只好**接受失敗**。」

61. **resign oneself to + -ing**

> “She resigned herself to working late.”

「她只好**無奈接受要加班**。」

Very useful grammar.

62. **resign oneself to the inevitable = 接受無可避免的事實**

A high-value fixed expression.

> “Eventually he resigned himself to the inevitable.”

「最後他只好**接受無可避免的現實**。」

63. **resign oneself to one's fate = 認命**

Often literary:

> 「接受自己的命運 / 認命」

W. **BE RESIGNED TO**

64. **be resigned to X = have accepted something unpleasant as unavoidable (已無奈接受) **

Practice

> “She was resigned to the delay.”

「她已經**無奈接受這次延誤**。」

Here **resigned** is functioning adjectivally.

65. **be resigned to doing something**

> “He was resigned to losing the money.”

「他已經**接受可能會失去那筆錢**。」

X. **RESIGNED** = ACCEPTING WITHOUT RESISTANCE

66. **resigned = showing acceptance of an unpleasant situation that seems unavoidable (無奈接受的 ; 認命的) **

> “He gave a resigned sigh.”

「他**無奈地嘆了一口氣**。」

This is an independent adjective sense.

67. **resigned expression / look = 無奈的表情**

> “She gave him a resigned look.”

「她以一個**無奈的眼神**看着他。」

68. **resigned smile = 無奈的微笑**

A smile expressing:

> “I don't like this, but there is little I can do.”

69. **resigned tone / voice = 無奈的語氣**

70. **resigned acceptance = 無奈接受 / 認命**

> “There was a sense of resigned acceptance.”

「有一種**無奈接受現實**的感覺。」

Y. **RESIGNEDLY**

71. **resignedly = in a way that shows reluctant acceptance (無奈地 ; 認命地) **

> “‘All right,’ he said resignedly.”

「『好吧。』他**無奈地**說。」

Valid but less common than:

> with resignation
> in a resigned tone.

Z. RESIGNATION = ACT OF QUITTING A POSITION

72. **resignation = act of formally giving up a job/position (辭職 ; 辭呈) **

> “Her resignation surprised everyone.”

「她的**辭職**令大家感到意外。」

73. **announce one's resignation = 宣布辭職**

> “He announced his resignation.”

「他宣布**辭職**。」

74. **resignation announcement = 辭職公告**

75. **resignation takes effect**

As above:

> resignation becomes formally effective.

AA. RESIGNATION = WRITTEN NOTICE

76. **resignation = formal notice/communication of resignation (辭呈) **

> “The board received her resignation.”

「董事會收到她的**辭呈**。」

Here **resignation** may metonymically refer to:

> the formal notice/document.

Compare:

> resignation letter

which is explicitly the physical/written document.

AB. RESIGNATION = RELUCTANT ACCEPTANCE

77. **resignation = quiet acceptance of something unpleasant that cannot be changed (無奈 ; 認命)**

A completely different noun branch.

> “He accepted the result with resignation.”

「他**無奈地接受**了結果。」

78. **with resignation = 無奈地**

> “She sighed with resignation.”

「她**無奈地**嘆了口氣。」

79. **a sense of resignation = 無奈感 / 認命感**

> “There was a sense of resignation in his voice.”

「他的聲音帶着一種**無奈感**。」

80. **air of resignation = 認命 / 無奈的神情**

Formal/literary:

> “He had an air of resignation.”

「他流露出一種**認命的神情**。」

81. **resignation to fate = 接受命運**

Formal/literary/religious.

AC. RELIGIOUS / LITERARY RESIGNATION

82. **resignation = humble acceptance of divine will/fate (順從天意 ; 安然接受命運) — older/formal**

Historical religious writing may praise:

> resignation to God's will

meaning:

> calmly submitting to what is regarded as divine will.

This is part of the **acceptance** branch.

AD. RESIGNATION VS DESPAIR

Important distinction.

resignation

= acceptance that something unpleasant cannot/will not be changed.

despair

= loss of hope.

A person can be resigned without feeling complete despair.

AE. RESIGNATION VS ACCEPTANCE

acceptance

neutral and broad.

resignation

often implies:

- * reluctance;
- * disappointment;
- * lack of better alternative;
- * belief that resistance is useless.

- > calm acceptance
- > resigned acceptance

The second sounds much more reluctant.

AF. IMPORTANT DISTINCTIONS: RESIGN vs QUIT

resign

- * more formal;
- * especially jobs/offices;
- * formally relinquish position.

quit

- * more conversational;
- * much broader.

You can:

- > quit smoking
- > quit a game
- > quit school
- > quit your job.

But **resign** normally refers to:

- > a formal position/job/office

or its special game/acceptance senses.

AG. RESIGN vs LEAVE

leave a job

very broad and neutral.

You may leave because you:

- * resign;
- * retire;
- * are dismissed;
- * contract ends;
- * transfer.

resign

specifically says:

> you formally gave up the role yourself.

AH. RESIGN vs STEP DOWN

resign

formally give up a job/office.

step down

leave a particular position, especially a senior role.

A person can:

> step down as CEO

but remain employed by the organization in another role.

Therefore:

> step down ≠ always leave organization.

AI. RESIGN vs RETIRE

resign

leave a particular position voluntarily.

retire

withdraw from regular career/work, often after reaching a certain age/stage.

A 25-year-old can resign normally.

Calling the same move **retirement** would usually imply something quite different.

Directly relevant to Kam Chai.

AJ. RESIGN vs FIRE / DISMISS

resign

departure formally initiated by employee/office-holder.

fire / dismiss

departure initiated by employer/authority.

> “He resigned.”

> 他辭職。

> “He was dismissed.”

> 他被解僱。

AK. RESIGN vs LAY OFF

resign

employee voluntarily leaves.

lay off

employer removes job/employment, usually because of organizational/economic reasons rather than the worker choosing to leave.

AL. RESIGN vs TERMINATE EMPLOYMENT

terminate employment

formal umbrella concept for ending employment.

Can be initiated by:

- * employer;
- * employee;
- * contract/event,

depending on wording.

resign

specifically the employee's relinquishment.

AM. RESIGN vs ABANDON

abandon

leave/give up completely, often without formal procedure.

resign

formally relinquish a role.

- > abandon a project
- > resign a position.

AN. RESIGN vs RELINQUISH

relinquish

formally give up:

- * control
- * possession
- * claim
- * right.

resign

modern core:

give up an office/job.

Older **resign** overlaps strongly with **relinquish**.

AO. RESIGN vs RENOUNCE

renounce

formally declare that one gives up/rejects:

- * claim

- * right

- * belief

- * title.

resign

normally leaves a position.

- > renounce citizenship

- > resign a directorship.

AP. RESIGN vs ABDICATE

abdicate

specifically give up sovereign/royal authority, or figuratively fail to fulfill responsibility.

resign

general office/job word.

A monarch typically:

- > abdicates the throne

rather than simply:

- > resigns the throne.

AQ. RESIGN vs SURRENDER

surrender

yield control/possession after pressure/conflict.

resign

formally relinquish office, or reflexively accept inevitability.

Older uses overlap.

AR. RESIGN vs WITHDRAW

withdraw

remove oneself from:

- * contest
- * process
- * application
- * participation.

resign

give up an existing office/job.

- > withdraw your application
- > resign your position.

AS. RESIGN vs CONCEDE — GAMES

resign a game

formally accept defeat and end play.

concede

admit defeat/point/claim more generally.

In chess:

> resign

is the conventional verb.

AT. RESIGNED vs PASSIVE

resigned

has accepted unpleasant reality as unavoidable.

passive

not active/assertive.

A resigned person may become passive, but the words are not equivalent.

AU. RESIGNED vs CONTENT

content

satisfied.

resigned

accepting despite dissatisfaction.

This is almost the opposite emotional nuance.

> resigned to the situation

> ≠ happy with the situation.

AV. RESIGNED vs RELUCTANT

reluctant

unwilling to do something.

resigned

has more or less stopped resisting because change appears impossible.

Sequence can be:

> reluctant → resistance fails → resigned.

AW. **RE-SIGN** — CRITICAL SPELLING/MEANING TRAP

83. **re-sign = sign again (重新簽約 / 再次簽署)**

This is a **separate word**.

> “The player re-signed with the club.”

「球員與球會**重新簽約**。」

Compare:

> “The player resigned from the club.”

「球員從球會**辭職 / 離任**。」

These can mean almost opposite things.

84. **re-sign a contract = 重新簽署合約**

> “Both parties re-signed the document.”

「雙方**重新簽署**了文件。」

85. **re-sign with a team/company = 續約 / 重新簽約**

Especially sports/employment reporting:

> re-sign with the team

= 跟球隊再次簽約。

86. ****resign vs re-sign — pronunciation distinction****

Although the spellings are visually very similar:

* ****resign**** = quit / relinquish

* ****re-sign**** = sign again

They are pronounced differently, which normally removes ambiguity in speech.

The hyphen in ****re-sign**** is particularly useful in writing.

AX. GRAMMAR

87. ****resign — no object****

> “I resigned.”

Complete sentence.

88. ****resign from + job/organization****

> resign from the company

> resign from office.

89. ****resign as + role****

> resign as manager.

90. ****resign + position/post****

> resign one's position

> resign one's post.

Formal transitive use.

91. ****resign over + issue****

> resign over the controversy.

92. ****resign in + manner/circumstance****

> resign in protest

> resign in disgrace.

93. ****resign on + grounds/principle****

> resign on principle

> resign on health grounds.

94. ****resign oneself to + noun/-ing****

> resign oneself to defeat

> resign oneself to waiting.

This is a completely different semantic branch.

95. ****be resigned to + noun/-ing****

> be resigned to the situation

> be resigned to losing.

AY. COUNTABILITY

****resignation — act/event****

Countable:

> a resignation

> three resignations.

> “The organization received five resignations.”

「機構收到五份辭呈 / 有五人辭職。」

resignation — reluctant acceptance

Usually uncountable:

> with resignation

> a sense of resignation.

resignation — notice/document

Can function countably/metonymically:

> “We received his resignation.”

= 收到他的辭呈。

AZ. FAMILY MAP

Family member / branch	Main meaning
-----	-----
resign — employment	voluntarily/formally give up a job
resign — office	give up an official role/position
resign — organization	leave a board, committee, association, etc.
resign — military	give up one's commission
resign — game	concede defeat and stop playing
resign — older/formal	relinquish a right, claim, authority, possession
resign oneself to	reluctantly accept something as unavoidable
resignation — employment	act/formal notice of leaving a position
resignation — attitude	reluctant, passive acceptance of an unpleasant reality
resigned — adjective	having accepted something unpleasant as unavoidable
resignedly	in a resigned, reluctant-acceptance manner
re-sign	completely separate word: sign again

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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resign — job	由自己正式提出離開現有工作；辭職	
resign from a company/job	從某公司 / 工作辭職	
resign as X	辭去 X 這個特定職位 / 身分	
resign one's position/post	正式辭去自己的職位	
resign from office	辭去所擔任的公職 / 正式職務	
resign from the board	辭去董事 / 委員會職務	
resign with immediate effect	辭職立即生效	
resign over X	因 X 事件 / 爭議而辭職	
resign for personal reasons	因私人原因辭職	
resign in protest	以辭職行動表達抗議	
resign on principle	因原則問題而辭職	
resign under pressure	在外界 / 組織壓力下辭職	
be asked/forced to resign	被要求 / 迫使以辭職形式離任	
resign in disgrace	因醜聞 / 失敗而聲譽受損地離職	
give notice	正式通知僱主自己將離職	
resignation letter	正式通知僱主辭職的辭職信	
hand in one's resignation	遞交辭呈	
submit one's resignation	正式提交辭呈	
tender one's resignation	非常正式：呈交辭呈	
accept a resignation	機構正式接受某人的辭呈	
withdraw a resignation	撤回先前提交的辭職決定 / 辭呈	
resignation takes effect	辭職正式生效	
mass resignation	多人同時 / 短時間內集體辭職	
wave of resignations	辭職潮	
resign one's commission	軍官正式辭去其委任 / 軍職	
resign a game — chess	承認敗局並主動結束比賽；認輸	
resignation — chess	主動承認失敗並終止棋局	
resign a right/claim — old/formal	正式放棄一項權利 / 主張；較舊式	
resign oneself to X	認為 X 無法改變，因此無奈地接受	
resign oneself to the inevitable	無奈接受無法避免的事情	
be resigned to X	已經認命 / 無奈接受 X	
resigned — adjective	雖不滿意，但已不再抗拒現實的；無奈的	
resigned look/sigh/smile	表現出「無可奈何，只能接受」的眼神 / 嘆息 / 微笑	
resignedly	無奈地、認命地	
resignation — quitting	辭去工作 / 職務的行為或正式通知	
resignation — acceptance	對不愉快但似乎無法改變的事所表現出的無奈接受	
with resignation	以無奈、認命的態度	
sense/air of resignation	無奈 / 認命的情緒或神態	
re-sign	與 resign 無關：再次簽署 / 重新簽約	

For your original passage

> “On balance, my advice is clear: do not **resign immediately**.”

The exact meaning is:

> **Kam Chai should not formally leave his current job yet, even though he is attracted to starting the café.**

The writer later deliberately contrasts two possible actions:

> **resign immediately**

> → give up salary and employment security now

versus:

> **accept the promotion for now**

> → keep earning, save capital, learn management skills, test the café concept, and resign later only if the plan becomes solid.

So **resign** here carries a stronger, more formal sense than merely:

> “stop liking the job”

> or

> “think about leaving.”

It means actually **terminate one's position voluntarily**.

For your core database, I would keep **4 principal semantic branches**:

1. **voluntarily/formally leave a job, office, or institutional position**
2. **games, especially chess: concede defeat and stop playing**
3. **resign oneself to / be resigned to = reluctantly accept an unavoidable unpleasant reality**
4. **older/formal: relinquish a right, claim, possession, authority, or office**

Then separately index **resignation = quitting vs reluctant acceptance**, **resigned = 無奈接受的**, **resignedly**, and especially **re-sign = sign again**, because confusing **resign** and **re-sign** can reverse the intended meaning almost completely.